

Cauchy-characteristic matching for the Z4c evolution system: method

z4c-CMM verified research loop¹

¹generated from the mission-2 knowledge ledger (*knowledge-database/paper_z4c-CCM/*);
every equation and number below is traceable to a verifier output under *results/numerical/*
(Dated: June 12, 2026)

I. METHOD

Black equations are transcribed from Refs. [1–3]; **dark blue** equations constitute the new Z4c-CCM formulation. Verification labels [Vn] refer to Table I; dynamical evidence is in Table II.

A. Boundary frame and Z4c variables

$$ds^2 = -\alpha^2 dt^2 + \gamma_{ij} (dx^i + \beta^i dt)(dx^j + \beta^j dt), \quad n^\mu = \alpha^{-1} (1, -\beta^i), \quad (1)$$

$$s_i = \frac{\partial_i r}{\sqrt{\gamma_{rr}}}, \quad s^i = \frac{\gamma^{ir}}{\sqrt{\gamma_{rr}}}, \quad m^A = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (e_2 + i e_3)^A, \quad (2)$$

$$\mathring{l}^\mu = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (n^\mu + s^\mu), \quad \mathring{k}^\mu = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (n^\mu - s^\mu) \quad [1]. \quad (3)$$

Z4c variables [1]:

$$\chi = (\det \gamma)^{-1/3}, \quad \tilde{\gamma}_{ij} = \chi \gamma_{ij}, \quad K = \hat{K} + 2\Theta, \quad \tilde{A}_{ij} = \chi \left(K_{ij} - \frac{1}{3} \gamma_{ij} K \right), \quad (4)$$

$$\partial_t \chi = \frac{2}{3} \chi [\alpha (\hat{K} + 2\Theta) - D_i \beta^i], \quad (5)$$

$$\partial_t \tilde{\gamma}_{ij} = -2\alpha \tilde{A}_{ij} + \beta^k \tilde{\gamma}_{ij,k} + 2\tilde{\gamma}_{k(i} \beta_{j)}^k - \frac{2}{3} \tilde{\gamma}_{ij} \beta^k{}_{,k} \quad [1]. \quad (6)$$

B. Worldtube data map (node N1)

$$g_{00} = -\alpha^2 + \gamma_{ij} \beta^i \beta^j, \quad g_{0i} = \gamma_{ij} \beta^j, \quad g_{ij} = \gamma_{ij}; \quad g^{00} = -\alpha^{-2}, \quad g^{0i} = \frac{\beta^i}{\alpha^2}, \quad g^{ij} = \gamma^{ij} - \frac{\beta^i \beta^j}{\alpha^2}. \quad (7)$$

ADM kinematics requires $\partial_t \gamma_{ij} = -2\alpha K_{ij} + \beta^k \partial_k \gamma_{ij} + \gamma_{kj} \partial_i \beta^k + \gamma_{ik} \partial_j \beta^k$. From $\gamma_{ij} = \chi^{-1} \tilde{\gamma}_{ij}$,

$$\partial_t \gamma_{ij} = \chi^{-1} \partial_t \tilde{\gamma}_{ij} - \chi^{-2} \tilde{\gamma}_{ij} \partial_t \chi, \quad (8)$$

and inserting (5)–(6) with $K_{ij} = \chi^{-1} (\tilde{A}_{ij} + \frac{1}{3} \tilde{\gamma}_{ij} K)$, $\beta^k \partial_k \gamma_{ij} = \chi^{-1} \beta^k \partial_k \tilde{\gamma}_{ij} - \gamma_{ij} \beta^k \partial_k \ln \chi$,

$$[\partial_t \gamma_{ij}]_{\text{Z4c}} - [\partial_t \gamma_{ij}]_{\text{ADM}} = \gamma_{ij} \left[\frac{2}{3} D_k \beta^k - \frac{2}{3} \partial_k \beta^k + \beta^k \partial_k \ln \chi \right]. \quad (9)$$

$D_i \beta^i = \partial_k \beta^k - \frac{3}{2} \beta^k \partial_k \ln \chi$

[V3: closure exact; naive $D = \partial_k \beta^k$ leaves residual $+1 \cdot \gamma_{ij} \beta^k \partial_k \ln \chi$]. (10)

C. Tetrad correspondence and Type-II boost (node N2)

Outgoing null label u with $u|_{\partial\Omega} = t$: $\partial_\mu u = (1, u_r, 0, 0)$,

$$g^{tt} + 2g^{tr}u_r + g^{rr}u_r^2 = 0 \implies u_r = \frac{-g^{tr} - \sqrt{(g^{tr})^2 - g^{tt}g^{rr}}}{g^{rr}}, \quad u_r|_{\text{flat}} = -1. \quad (11)$$

Characteristic outgoing null vector [2, 3]:

$$\hat{l}^\mu = -e^{2\hat{\beta}} g^{\mu\nu} \partial_\nu u. \quad (12)$$

For arbitrary $(\alpha, \beta^i, \gamma_{ij})$,

$$\hat{l}^\mu = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} (\alpha - \gamma_{ij}\beta^i s^j) e^{-2\hat{\beta}} \hat{l}^\mu \quad [\text{V1: exact at 12 rational points; GPU residual } 9.3 \times 10^{-16}], \quad (13)$$

$$A = (\alpha - \gamma_{ij}\beta^i s^j) e^{-2\hat{\beta}}, \quad \psi'_0 = A^2 \psi_0, \quad (14)$$

i.e. the Choice-2 boost of Ref. [3] holds verbatim on the Z4c frame (3): no evolution-system variable enters (13). ψ_0 on the characteristic grid [2, 3]:

$$\psi_0 = \left(\frac{r\partial_r\beta - 1}{4Kr} \right) \left[(1+K)\partial_r J - \frac{J^2\partial_r\bar{J}}{1+K} \right] + \frac{J(1+K^2)\partial_r J \partial_r\bar{J}}{8K^3} + \frac{1}{8K} \left[\frac{J^2\partial_r^2\bar{J}}{1+K} - (1+K)\partial_r^2 J \right] - \frac{J\bar{J}^2(\partial_r J)^2 + J^3(\partial_r\bar{J})^2}{16K^3}. \quad (15)$$

D. Physical-mode dictionary (node N3)

Linear TT perturbation on the frame (2), $\gamma_{AB} = \delta_{AB} + h_{AB}(t, x_s)$, $h_{22} = -h_{33} \equiv F_1$, $h_{23} \equiv F_2$, $h_{mm} = F_1 + iF_2$; $\psi_0 \equiv -C_{abcd} l^a m^b l^c m^d$ on $l = \hat{l}$, $m = m^A$. Direct evaluation of the linearized Riemann tensor gives, off shell (no field equations used),

$$\psi_0 = \frac{1}{4} (\partial_t + \partial_s)^2 h_{mm} \quad [\text{V2: exact for arbitrary } F_1, F_2], \quad (16)$$

$$(\partial_t + \partial_s)^2 \gamma_{AB}^{\text{TF}} = 4 \left(\psi_0 \bar{m}_A \bar{m}_B + \bar{\psi}_0 m_A m_B \right), \quad (\hat{l} \cdot \partial)^2 \gamma_{AB}^{\text{TF}} = 2 \left(\psi'_0 \bar{m}_A \bar{m}_B + \bar{\psi}'_0 m_A m_B \right) \quad (17)$$

[V2: GPU residual 0.0 over 4,194,304 off-shell Fourier modes]. $(\hat{l} \cdot \partial)$ annihilates outgoing waves $f(t - x_s)$: (17) is transparent to them.

E. The Z4c-CCM boundary conditions (node N6)

Ten incoming modes at the worldtube; $X_v^\mu = (n^\mu + \sqrt{v} s^\mu)/\sqrt{2}$ at sector speed v ; $L \geq 1$:

$$\text{physical (2):} \quad (\hat{l} \cdot \partial)^2 \gamma_{AB}^{\text{TF}} \hat{=} 2 \left(\psi'_0 \bar{m}_A \bar{m}_B + \bar{\psi}'_0 m_A m_B \right), \quad \psi'_0 = A^2 \psi_0^{\text{CCE}}, \quad (18)$$

$$\text{constraint (4):} \quad (r^2 \hat{l} \cdot \partial)^{L+1} \Theta \hat{=} 0, \quad (r^2 \hat{l} \cdot \partial)^{L+1} Z_s \hat{=} 0, \quad (r^2 \hat{l} \cdot \partial)^{L+1} Z_A \hat{=} 0, \quad (19)$$

$$\text{gauge (4):} \quad (r^2 \hat{m} \cdot \partial)^{L+1} \alpha \hat{=} 0, \quad (r^2 \hat{k}_{\nu_s} \cdot \partial)^{L+1} \beta_s \hat{=} 0, \quad (r^2 \hat{j} \cdot \partial)^{L+1} \beta_A \hat{=} 0. \quad (20)$$

Björhus form of (18), with $V_{AB} \equiv (\hat{l} \cdot \partial) \gamma_{AB}^{\text{TF}}$:

$$(\hat{l} \cdot \partial) V_{AB}|_{\partial\Omega} = 2 \left(\psi'_0 \bar{m}_A \bar{m}_B + \bar{\psi}'_0 m_A m_B \right); \quad \psi_0^{\text{CCE}} \rightarrow 0 \implies \text{CPBC scheme of Ref. [1] [V6]}. \quad (21)$$

Equations (19)–(20) are the order- L conditions of Ref. [1]; (20) replaces the Sommerfeld gauge placeholder of Ref. [3].

F. Sector orthogonality (nodes N4, N5)

For arbitrary TT data $h_{AB}(t, x_s)$ [V4]:

$$\mathcal{H} = \partial_i \partial_j h_{ij} - \partial^2 h^k_k = 0, \quad \mathcal{M}_i = \partial_j \dot{h}_{ij} - \partial_i \dot{h}^j_j = 0, \quad \gamma^{ij} \partial_t h_{ij} = 0, \quad \tilde{\Gamma}^i = -\partial_j \tilde{h}^{ij} = 0; \quad (22)$$

negative controls: $h_{x_s y} = G(t, x_s) \Rightarrow \mathcal{M}_y = -\frac{1}{2} \partial_{x_s} \dot{G} \neq 0$; $h_{yy} = h_{zz} = G \Rightarrow \mathcal{H} = -2 \partial_{x_s}^2 G \neq 0$.

Hence the datum (18) sources neither (19) nor (20) at linear order: the three sectors of (18)–(20) commute.

On the boundary wave model of Ref. [1], $[\partial_t^2 - 2\dot{\beta} \partial_t \partial_x - (1 - \dot{\beta}^2) \partial_x^2] u = 0$, plane-wave reflection [V5]:

$$R_{\text{Sommerfeld}} = -\frac{\dot{\beta}(1 - \dot{\beta})}{(1 + \dot{\beta})(2 - \dot{\beta})} \neq 0, \quad R_{(\partial_t + c_+ \partial_x)} = 0 \quad (\text{identically}). \quad (23)$$

G. Frozen-coefficient boundary stability (node N7)

Laplace–Fourier ansatz $u = \tilde{u} e^{st + \lambda x}$, $\Re s > 0$ [V7]:

$$\lambda_+ = \frac{s}{1 + \dot{\beta}} \text{ (admissible)}, \quad \lambda_- = -\frac{s}{1 - \dot{\beta}}, \quad D_L(s) = \left(s + (1 + \dot{\beta}) \lambda_+ \right)^{L+1} = (2s)^{L+1}, \quad \frac{|D_L(s)|}{|s|^{L+1}} = 2^{L+1}. \quad (24)$$

D_L contains no datum symbol: the injection (18) modifies only the inhomogeneity, so the boundary-stability results of Ref. [1] (constraint sector: all L ; gauge+metric sector: spherical reduction, asymptotically harmonic shift) transfer verbatim with $\|u\| \leq C \|\psi'_0\text{-datum}\|$.

H. Numerical evidence

All runs: JAX float64, $4 \times$ NVIDIA A100-80GB (CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES=0,1,2,3), wall clock ≤ 23 s each (budget 600 s); outputs under `results/numerical/`.

Table I. Symbolic and sampling verification of (10)–(24). “Exact” = sympy identity on arbitrary functions or exact rationals (zero float error). Files: `n2_boost_check.txt`, `n3_dictionary_check.txt`, `n1_varmap_check.txt`, `n4_cpbc_compat_check.txt`, `n5_gauge_check.txt`, `n6_composite_check.txt`, `n7_lf_sketch_check.txt`.

verified statement	exact part	GPU sweep (4 devices)
V1 boost identity (13), factor $\sqrt{2}/2$	12/12 rational points	9.34×10^{-16} over 4,194,304 samples
V2 dictionary (16)–(17), $c = \frac{1}{4}$, $K = 4$	arbitrary F_1, F_2 , off shell	0.0 over 4,194,304 off-shell modes
V3 maps (7), closure (10)	full-symbol identities	round trip 4.10×10^{-16} , gg^{-1} 8.88×10^{-16}
V4 orthogonality (22) + controls	identities and non-vanishing controls	TT residual 0.0 vs control 12.3
V5 reflection (23)	exact R algebra	$ R_{\text{Som}} \geq 0.023$ on $\dot{\beta} \in [0.05, 0.6]$; $R = 0$ exact
V6 10-mode count, $\psi_0 \rightarrow 0$ reduction, wire-through structural		reduction 0.0; chain residual 2.92×10^{-16}
V7 Kreiss condition (24), $L = 0..3$	$D_L = (2s)^{L+1}$ exact	ratio deviation 3.2×10^{-14} (4,194,304 samples)

Table II. Dynamical model evolution (FD2+RK4, shift $\dot{\beta} = 0.3$, outgoing Gaussian pulse onto the boundary; one configuration per GPU; `n8_model1d_test.txt`). The orientation of the discrete model gives the $\dot{\beta} \rightarrow -\dot{\beta}$ mirror of (23); the exact characteristic ratio at the boundary is $q_{\text{in}}/q_{\text{out}} = \dot{\beta}/(2 + \dot{\beta})$.

boundary condition	measured	exact	deviation
Sommerfeld, q -ratio	0.1305	0.1304	0.03%
Sommerfeld, R_u	0.2423	0.2422	0.04%
$(\partial_t + c_+ \partial_x)$ [P1/CCM op., $N=4097$]	$R = 3.24 \times 10^{-15}$	0	machine precision
CCM injection (21), rel. L_2 vs exact pulse	1.09×10^{-4}	0	two-way transparent

[1] M. Ruiz, D. Hilditch, and S. Bernuzzi, Constraint preserving boundary conditions for the Z4c formulation of general relativity (2010), local source: `ref-paper/arxiv-1010.0523v2/`, [arXiv:1010.0523](https://arxiv.org/abs/1010.0523) [gr-qc].

- [2] J. Moxon, M. A. Scheel, and S. A. Teukolsky, Improved Cauchy-characteristic evolution system for high-precision numerical relativity waveforms (2020), local source: [ref-paper/arxiv-2007.01339/](#), [arXiv:2007.01339 \[gr-qc\]](#).
- [3] S. Ma *et al.*, Fully relativistic three-dimensional Cauchy-characteristic matching for physical degrees of freedom (2023), local source: [ref-paper/arxiv-2308.10361/](#), [arXiv:2308.10361 \[gr-qc\]](#).